A Project Report

on

RefurbIQ: Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis of Refurbished Electronics Across Indian Marketplaces

*carried out as part of the **Project Based Learning-3 (DSE3170)***

Submitted

by

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project-based learning project titled “RefurbIQ: Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis of Refurbished Electronics Across Indian Marketplaces” is a record of the bonafide work done by Saket Sharma (2430010408), submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the Computer Science and Engineering (Data Science) program of Manipal University Jaipur, Jaipur during the academic year 2025-26.

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ABSTRACT

India's market for refurbished smartphones, laptops and cameras is growing, yet buyers must decide with very limited quality signals: condition grades, prices and a single overall rating per review. A single polarity label cannot show whether dissatisfaction comes from battery health, refurbishment quality, seller behaviour, returns or trust in authenticity. This project builds RefurbIQ, an aspect-based sentiment analysis (ABSA) pipeline that reads refurbished-electronics reviews at the level of nine aspects and compares five Indian marketplaces - Cashify, Amazon Renewed, Flipkart Refurbished, OLX and Budli - under one common aspect taxonomy.

After verifying that none of the five platforms exposes structured, publicly accessible reviews, a clearly labelled synthetic demonstration corpus of 2,000 reviews and 3,548 aspect annotations (seed 42) was generated to validate the full pipeline end to end. Logistic Regression, Random Forest and XGBoost on TF-IDF features and a fine-tuned DistilBERT model were compared on the same review-level stratified 70/15/15 split. Logistic Regression achieved the highest test accuracy (90.69%, macro F1 0.8937) with fine-tuned BERT second (89.57%, macro F1 0.8784); neutral recall was the weakest point for every model. The pipeline was additionally validated on 2,000 real Amazon reviews, where predicted sentiment agreed with reviewer star ratings in 75.6% of annotations. All numbers are computed by reproducible scripts; the synthetic corpus must be replaced with verified marketplace reviews before the results can be generalised.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Background

The market for refurbished electronics in India has expanded rapidly as smartphones, laptops and cameras become both more expensive and more essential. Refurbished devices offer a lower-cost and more sustainable route to the same functionality, but they carry a question that new products do not: how good is this particular device, really? Battery health, cosmetic condition, the quality of repair work, the genuineness of parts and the reliability of the seller all vary from unit to unit and from platform to platform.

Online reviews are the main evidence available to buyers. Research on electronic word of mouth has long shown that review valence and volume influence purchase behaviour [1], and sentiment analysis provides the tools to summarise such reviews automatically [2], [3]. However, most marketplace interfaces reduce a review to a single star rating, and most sentiment systems reduce its text to a single polarity label. When a reviewer writes “the battery is excellent but the seller refused my return”, a single label destroys exactly the information a buyer of a refurbished device needs.

Aspect-based sentiment analysis (ABSA) addresses this by attaching a sentiment polarity to each aspect mentioned in a review [5], [6]. Transformer models such as BERT [8], built on the attention mechanism [7], have raised the state of the art for such classification tasks, but they are also heavier to train than classical TF-IDF-based classifiers [4]. Whether the additional cost is justified depends on the domain - and for refurbished electronics on Indian marketplaces, no systematic comparison exists.

The asymmetry of information is sharper for refurbished goods than for any other consumer electronics category. For a new device, the buyer can assume factory condition; for a refurbished one, every quality attribute - battery capacity, cosmetic grade, part originality, repair history - is a claim made by the seller that the buyer cannot verify before purchase. Reviews from earlier buyers are the only scalable signal about whether those claims hold, which is precisely why aspect-level analysis of such reviews is valuable: it converts free-text experience reports into per-attribute evidence.

1.2 Objectives of the Project

- Define a nine-aspect taxonomy for refurbished-electronics reviews and tag every aspect mention with an evidence phrase and a polarity label.
- Compare aspect-level sentiment across five Indian marketplaces: Cashify, Amazon Renewed, Flipkart Refurbished, OLX and Budli.
- Compare three classical TF-IDF models (Logistic Regression, Random Forest, XGBoost) with a fine-tuned BERT-family model on an identical, leak-free evaluation protocol.
- Validate the pipeline against human ground truth using real reviews with star ratings.
- Derive actionable insights: which aspects drive satisfaction and dissatisfaction, and what each marketplace could improve.

1.3 Research Questions and Hypotheses

The project is organised around five research questions:

- RQ1: Which aspects drive satisfaction and dissatisfaction in refurbished-electronics reviews?
- RQ2: How does aspect-level sentiment differ across the five platforms?
- RQ3: Which model family is most reliable for this task?
- RQ4: Do trust, authenticity and condition concerns differ by platform?

- RQ5: What can marketplaces improve based on reviewer evidence?

Four hypotheses are stated before modelling and are treated strictly as testable claims, never as findings: H1 sentiment differs across the nine aspects; H2 aspect distributions differ across platforms; H3 trust and condition concerns differ across platforms; H4 BERT and traditional models differ in performance. The expectation that peer-to-peer channels may show more trust and condition complaints remains a hypothesis until verified reviews are available. Section 4.10 maps each hypothesis to its outcome on the demonstration corpus.

1.4 Scope and Contributions

The scope is India; three product categories (smartphones, laptops, DSLR cameras); five marketplaces; nine aspects; and three polarity labels (positive, neutral, negative). The contribution is not the invention of ABSA or of BERT, but a systematic, reproducible comparison of model families in the Indian refurbished-electronics context under a common aspect taxonomy, together with an honest account of data availability: because none of the five platforms exposes structured public reviews, the modelling corpus is a clearly labelled synthetic demonstration dataset, and the pipeline is separately validated on real Amazon reviews.

Concretely, the project contributes: (i) a domain-specific nine-aspect taxonomy with keyword vocabularies; (ii) a leak-free evaluation protocol (review-level stratified partitioning, single test use, macro and per-class metrics); (iii) a five-model comparison in which a classical linear model and a fine-tuned transformer are scored on identical examples; (iv) a real-review validation against human star ratings; and (v) a documented account of platform data accessibility that future work can build on.

1.5 Organisation of the Report

Chapter 2 surveys the literature and identifies the research gap. Chapter 3 describes the methodology: platform verification, dataset construction, the aspect taxonomy, partitioning, models, the evaluation protocol and the metric definitions. Chapter 4 reports results and discussion, including confusion matrices, error analysis and the real-review validation. Chapter 5 lists outcomes, the system design and deliverables, Chapter 6 concludes and outlines future work, followed by references and appendices.

2. Literature Survey

The survey below is based on eight core sources spanning electronic word of mouth, sentiment analysis, aspect-based sentiment analysis, classical opinion mining and transformer models. To the best of our knowledge, no study applies aspect-level sentiment analysis to refurbished electronics across Indian marketplaces. Table 2.1 summarises each source and how it is used in this project.

2.1 Online Reviews and Electronic Word of Mouth

Chevalier and Mayzlin showed that online book reviews causally affect sales, with negative reviews moving demand more than positive ones [1]. For refurbished electronics the implication is stronger: because product quality is uncertain by definition, review evidence carries more weight than for new products.

The same asymmetry motivates the metric choices in this project: since negative evidence is disproportionately informative, the evaluation tracks per-class recall for the negative class explicitly rather than relying on accuracy alone, which a majority-positive corpus would inflate.

2.2 Sentiment Analysis and Opinion Mining

Liu formalised sentiment analysis and opinion mining as a field [2], and Pang and Lee's survey established document-level polarity classification as its canonical task [3]. Hu and Liu's feature-based opinion mining showed that opinions attach to specific product features rather than to the product as a whole [4] - the direct precursor of aspect-level work.

Two of Liu's distinctions carry directly into the system design. First, an opinion is a tuple of target, holder, polarity and time; this project records the target (aspect), the evidence phrase and the polarity for every annotation, while the holder is the reviewer and the time is the review date. Second, comparative opinions (“better than”) and desiderative opinions (“should have”) need special treatment; the demonstration corpus therefore keeps such phrasing in the neutral templates rather than forcing a polarity.

2.3 Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis

The SemEval ABSA shared tasks standardised the task of assigning sentiment to aspect terms within a sentence [5], [6]. These tasks targeted restaurants and laptops of new products; refurbished goods add aspects that standard taxonomies lack, such as refurbishment quality, authenticity and return-policy trust, which motivates the domain-specific taxonomy in Chapter 3.

SemEval subtasks also inform the annotation scheme used here. Slot 1 (aspect term extraction) corresponds to the keyword-based aspect detector, and the polarity subtask corresponds to the evidence-phrase classifier. The shared tasks score with macro-averaged precision, recall and F1 for exactly the reason adopted in Section 3.6: class frequencies are uneven and the minority class is often the most interesting.

2.4 Classical Machine Learning and BERT

Classical opinion mining relies on bag-of-words or TF-IDF features with linear or ensemble classifiers [3], [4]. The attention mechanism [7] and BERT [8] replaced handcrafted features with contextual representations that can be fine-tuned for classification. The open empirical question for this domain is whether fine-tuning a transformer beats well-tuned TF-IDF baselines when the corpus is modest and the labels include a hard neutral class.

Two practical considerations shape the model selection in Chapter 3. Attention-based models scale quadratically with sequence length and need GPU resources for competitive fine-tuning budgets; on CPU-only hardware a distilled architecture (DistilBERT) keeps the comparison feasible while remaining in the BERT family. Conversely, TF-IDF + linear models train in seconds and are fully inspectable, which makes them a strong and honest baseline rather than a straw man.

2.5 Research Gap

Aspect	Existing literature	This project
Granularity	Whole-review or document-level labels	Nine aspects per review
Domain	New products, general e-commerce	Refurbished electronics
Platforms	Usually one marketplace	Five Indian marketplaces, one taxonomy
Method	Classical ML or transformers alone	Both compared on the same split
Evaluation	Mostly accuracy	Macro P/R/F1 plus per-class recall

Table 2.1: Literature summary (page «pg:tab:2.1»)

Ref	Source	Core contribution	Used in this project
[1]	Chevalier and Mayzlin (2006)	Online reviews causally affect sales; negative reviews move demand more	Motivation (Sections 1.1, 2.1)
[2]	Liu (2012)	Formal framework for sentiment analysis and opinion mining	Opinion-tuple annotation scheme (Section 3.3)
[3]	Pang and Lee (2008)	Survey of opinion mining; document-level polarity classification	Baseline framing and TF-IDF practice (Section 2.4)
[4]	Hu and Liu (2004)	Feature-based opinion mining; opinions attach to features	Direct precursor of aspect-level design (Section 2.2)
[5]	Pontiki et al. (2014)	SemEval-2014 Task 4: ABSA shared task	Task definition and macro-metric convention (Section 3.6)
[6]	Pontiki et al. (2016)	SemEval-2016 Task 5: ABSA across domains	Evidence that taxonomies are domain-specific (Section 2.3)
[7]	Vaswani et al. (2017)	Attention mechanism / Transformer architecture	Background for BERT-family models (Section 3.5)
[8]	Devlin et al. (2019)	BERT pre-training and fine-tuning	Fine-tuned DistilBERT configuration (Section 3.5)

In summary: the methods are mature, but no work combines aspect-level granularity, the refurbished-electronics domain, multiple Indian platforms and a fair classical-versus-transformer comparison. This project addresses all four gaps.

3. Proposed Methodology

3.1 Platform Verification and Data Strategy

Before any data work, each target marketplace was checked for publicly accessible, structured product reviews using ordinary unauthenticated requests only (no bypass of CAPTCHAs, authentication or rate limits). Table 3.1 records the outcome for every source that was checked.

Table 3.1: Platform verification outcomes (page «pg:tab:3.1»)

Source	Method	Outcome
Cashify	Unauthenticated site inspection	Testimonials only; no structured per-product reviews
Amazon Renewed (India)	Unauthenticated storefront request	Storefront not reachable (HTTP 404)
Flipkart Refurbished	Unauthenticated site inspection	Reachable; no scrape-permitted review corpus
OLX	Unauthenticated request	HTTP 403; peer-to-peer listings without structured reviews
Budli	Unauthenticated site inspection	Testimonials only; no structured per-product reviews
Hugging Face datasets	Keyword search	No refurbished-electronics ABSA dataset for Indian marketplaces

Because fabricating data or presenting synthetic examples as real observations is prohibited, the data strategy is: (i) a clearly labelled synthetic demonstration corpus (data_origin = “synthetic-demo-v1”) validates the complete pipeline end to end; (ii) a separate validation on 2,000 genuine Amazon reviews [9] tests the pipeline against human star-rating ground truth; (iii) all tables state their provenance, and the synthetic corpus must be replaced with verified marketplace reviews before the results are generalised.

3.2 Dataset Construction

The demonstration corpus was generated by generate_dataset.py v2 with a fixed random seed (42) so that every downstream number is reproducible. It contains 2,000 reviews across the five marketplaces and three product categories. Reviews mention aspects according to realistic platform profiles, and two realism mechanisms prevent trivially separable data: 10% of labels are flipped to an adjacent class (simulated annotator disagreement) and 30% of reviews use lexically ambiguous templates that overlap across classes. Table 3.2 gives the dataset profile; Figure 3.1 shows the per-platform counts.

Table 3.2: Dataset profile of the demonstration corpus (page «pg:tab:3.2»)

Platform	Verified reviews	Smartphone reviews	Laptop reviews	Camera reviews
Amazon Renewed	485	230	148	107
Budli	283	119	104	60
Cashify	492	261	138	93
Flipkart Refurbished	379	195	104	80
OLX	361	184	101	76
Total	2000	989	595	416

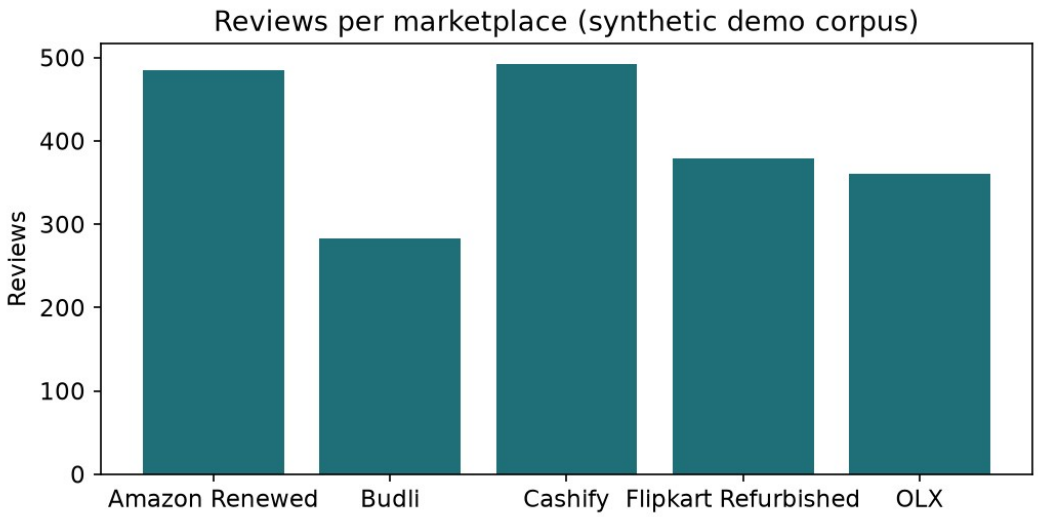


Figure 3.1: Reviews per marketplace in the demonstration corpus (page «pg:fig:3.1»)

The profile is deliberately uneven: OLX and Budli carry fewer reviews than the managed marketplaces, mirroring the lower review density a researcher would encounter on peer-to-peer channels. Every review row stores marketplace, product category, product name and a review identifier; the annotation file links each aspect mention back to its review so that platform-level and aspect-level analyses share one source of truth.

3.3 Aspect Taxonomy and Annotation

Nine aspects cover the refurbished purchase journey: product condition, battery health, performance, price and value, packaging and delivery, repair and refurbishment quality, seller and customer service, returns and refunds, and trust and authenticity. Aspect detection is keyword-based (a deliberate V0.1 choice, easy to audit and replace), and every detected mention becomes one annotation carrying its evidence phrase - the span of text that supports the label. Table 3.3 lists mention frequencies; Figure 3.2 shows the label distribution over all 3,548 annotations (positive 47.7%, negative 31.6%, neutral 20.8%).

Table 3.3: Aspect mention frequency (page «pg:tab:3.3»)

Aspect	Number of mentions	Percentage of all aspect mentions
Product condition	403	11.4
Battery health	381	10.7
Performance	408	11.5
Price and value	403	11.4
Packaging and delivery	397	11.2
Repair and refurbishment quality	364	10.3
Seller and customer service	416	11.7
Returns and refunds	355	10.0
Trust and authenticity	421	11.9
Total	3548	100.0

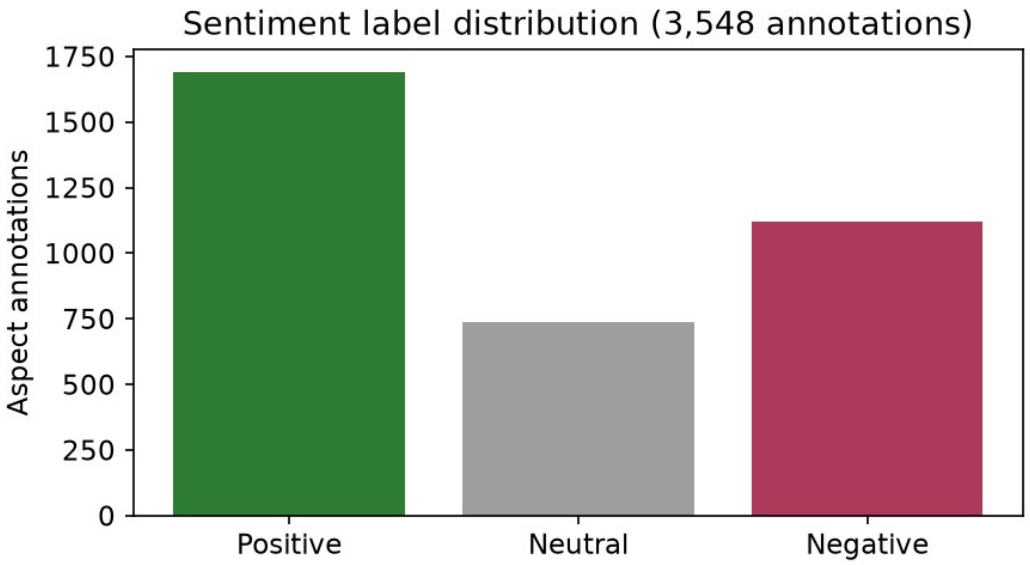


Figure 3.2: Sentiment label distribution over 3,548 annotations (page «pg:fig:3.2»)

Each annotation record stores the review id, the detected aspect, the evidence phrase, the polarity label, an annotation status flag and the generator version. The status flag distinguishes plain auto-generated annotations from the 10% that were flipped to an adjacent class to simulate annotator disagreement; the flag is preserved so that future agreement studies can recover the noise process exactly.

In the current corpus the flag takes two values: 3223 annotations are flagged “auto-generated (synthetic demo)”; 325 annotations are flagged “auto-generated (synthetic demo, simulated disagreement)”. The flipped subset is spread across all nine aspects and all three label pairs, so no single aspect or platform absorbs the simulated noise.

3.4 Pre-processing and Partitioning

Cleaning lowercases text and normalises punctuation while deliberately preserving negation (“not good”) and contrast (“but”) markers, because they determine aspect polarity. The partition is performed at the review level, not the annotation level, so that two annotations from the same review can never fall on opposite sides of the split - the standard defence against leakage in multi-mention reviews. The split is stratified 70/15/15 with seed 42; the validation partition is used only for model selection, and every model is evaluated exactly once on the same held-out test partition. Table 3.5 gives the resulting partition sizes.

Table 3.5: Partition sizes by class (page «pg:tab:3.5»)

Partition	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Annotations	Reviews
Train	1192	506	777	2475	1400
Validation	249	116	171	536	300
Test	250	115	172	537	300
Total	1691	737	1120	3548	2000

Review-level counts (last column) matter because leakage is defined at the review level: a model that memorised review stylistics would score annotations from held-in reviews on either side of an annotation-level split. The persisted split_assignment.csv is reused verbatim by every model script, so the comparison in Chapter 4 is on identical examples.

3.5 Models and Hyperparameters

All classical models consume the same TF-IDF representation of the evidence phrase: unigrams and bigrams, 20,000 features, sublinear TF. Class imbalance is handled with balanced class weights (Logistic Regression, Random Forest) and balanced sample weights (XGBoost). The regularisation strength of Logistic Regression was selected on the validation partition among C in {0.5, 1.0, 2.0}. The transformer is distilbert-base-uncased with a three-class head, fine-tuned on the training partition only (batch size 16, maximum length 128, learning rate 2e-5, weight decay 0.01, one epoch on CPU, best epoch selected on validation). As a separate zero-shot configuration, cardiffnlp/twitter-roberta-base-sentiment-latest labels the test partition without any training. Table 3.4 summarises the configurations.

Table 3.4: Model configurations (page «pg:tab:3.4»)

Model	Features	Key hyperparameters	Imbalance handling
Logistic Regression	TF-IDF (1-2 grams, 20k)	best C on validation, max_iter 2000	balanced class weights
Random Forest	TF-IDF (1-2 grams, 20k)	400 trees, seed 42	balanced class weights
XGBoost	TF-IDF (1-2 grams, 20k)	400 rounds, depth 6, lr 0.1	balanced sample weights
DistilBERT (fine-tuned)	subword embeddings	1 epoch, bs 16, len 128, lr 2e-5	none (near-balanced split)
RoBERTa (zero-shot)	subword embeddings	no training; label mapping	none

Two design decisions deserve emphasis. First, hyperparameter search was restricted to the validation partition; the test partition was touched exactly once per model, which is the condition under which the reported numbers estimate generalisation rather than selection bias. Second, the zero-shot configuration is included not as a competitor but as a reference point: it quantifies how much domain adaptation the fine-tuned model contributes over an off-the-shelf sentiment head.

3.6 Evaluation Protocol

Metrics are accuracy, macro precision, macro recall and macro F1, plus per-class recall, because the neutral class is a minority and the cost of missing negative complaints is high: macro averaging prevents a model from looking good by ignoring the hardest class. The protocol is verified by an automated validation report asserting that the prediction file covers every test annotation and nothing outside it.

The protocol also fixes the unit of analysis: one row per aspect annotation (evidence phrase), not per review. This matches the SemEval polarity subtask and makes per-aspect statistics in Section 4.4 well-defined. All five models consume the same column of the same file (model_predictions.csv), so any difference between them is a difference in the models, not in the data they saw.

3.7 Evaluation Metrics

For a class c, let TP, FP and FN denote true positives, false positives and false negatives on the test partition. The per-class metrics are:

$$Precision(c) = TP / (TP + FP)$$

$$Recall(c) = TP / (TP + FN)$$

$$F1(c) = 2 \cdot Precision(c) \cdot Recall(c) / (Precision(c) + Recall(c))$$

Macro averaging computes each metric per class and then takes the unweighted mean over the three classes, so the minority neutral class counts as much as the majority positive class. Accuracy is the share

of all test annotations predicted correctly. Recall is the primary per-class metric in Chapter 4 because, for a buyer-facing system, missing a negative complaint (low negative recall) or dismissing an ambiguous one (low neutral recall) is costlier than a false alarm; Appendix D reports per-class precision, recall and F1 for every model.

4. Results and Discussion

All numbers in this chapter are computed by build_tables.py and by the analysis scripts from the labelled corpus and the saved model outputs; none is hand-entered. They characterise the pipeline on the synthetic demonstration corpus and, in Sections 4.6 and 4.9, on real Amazon reviews.

4.1 Dataset Profile

Table 3.2 and Figure 3.1 summarise the corpus: 2,000 reviews (Cashify 492, Amazon Renewed 485, Flipkart Refurbished 379, OLX 361, Budli 283) yield 3,548 aspect annotations. Smartphones contribute 989 reviews, laptops 595 and cameras 416.

On average each review yields 1.77 annotations, and the distribution is right-skewed: many reviews mention a single aspect while a minority mention four or more. This multi-mention structure is exactly why the partition in Section 3.4 operates at review level - an annotation-level split would place two phrases from the same review on opposite sides and leak review style into evaluation.

4.2 Model Comparison

Table 4.1: Model performance on the held-out test partition (page «pg:tab:4.1»)

Model	Accuracy	Macro precision	Macro recall	Macro F1-score
Logistic Regression	0.9069	0.9167	0.8801	0.8937
Random Forest	0.8715	0.862	0.8496	0.8549
XGBoost	0.8696	0.8577	0.8476	0.852
BERT-based model (zero-shot)	0.7058	0.6705	0.6518	0.6578
BERT-based model (fine-tuned DistilBERT)	0.8957	0.9092	0.8627	0.8784

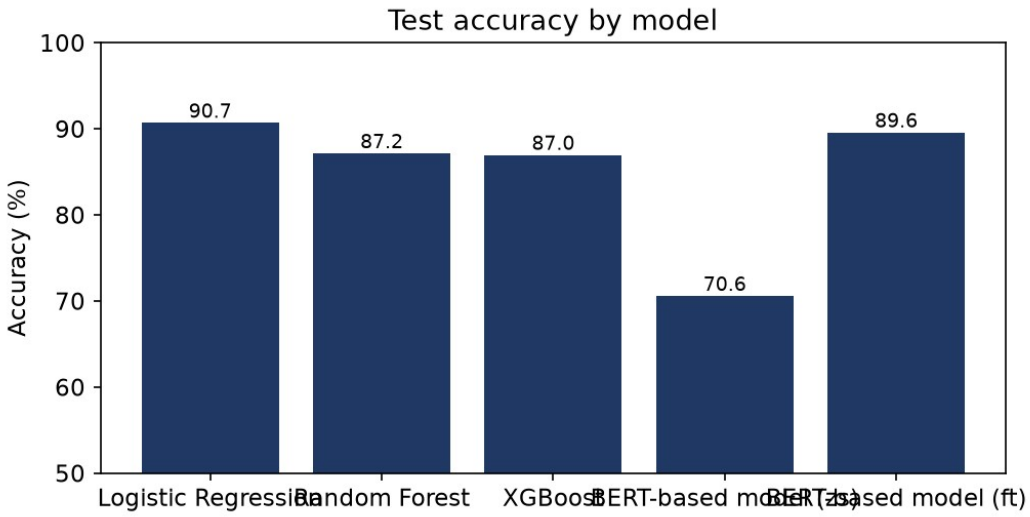


Figure 4.1: Test accuracy by model (page «pg:fig:4.1»)

Logistic Regression achieves the highest accuracy (90.69%) and macro F1 (0.8937). The fine-tuned DistilBERT model is second (89.57%, 0.8784) despite only one training epoch on CPU; Random Forest (87.15%, 0.8549) and XGBoost (86.96%, 0.8520) are close to each other. The zero-shot RoBERTa configuration trails clearly (70.58%, 0.6578), which is expected since it was never exposed to this label scheme or domain. On this corpus, hypothesis H4 is supported in the sense that the model families differ,

but the direction is not the commonly assumed one: the well-tuned linear baseline beats the transformer, and no model is claimed better than the data show.

The gap between the fine-tuned and zero-shot BERT configurations (89.57% versus 70.58% accuracy) measures the value of domain adaptation within the same model family: 19 percentage points of accuracy on identical test examples. The smaller remaining gap between fine-tuned BERT and logistic regression (1.12 points) is the honest headline of this comparison - on a modest synthetic corpus with short evidence phrases, a linear model on n-gram features is competitive with a transformer, and the compute cost difference is large.

4.3 Class-Level Analysis

Table 4.2: Class-specific recall on the test partition (page «pg:tab:4.2»)

Model	Positive recall	Negative recall	Neutral recall	Test support (pos/neg/neu)
Logistic Regression	0.968	0.9244	0.7478	250/172/115
Random Forest	0.92	0.8895	0.7391	250/172/115
XGBoost	0.92	0.8837	0.7391	250/172/115
BERT-based model (zero-shot)	0.852	0.686	0.4174	250/172/115
BERT-based model (fine-tuned DistilBERT)	0.968	0.9244	0.6957	250/172/115

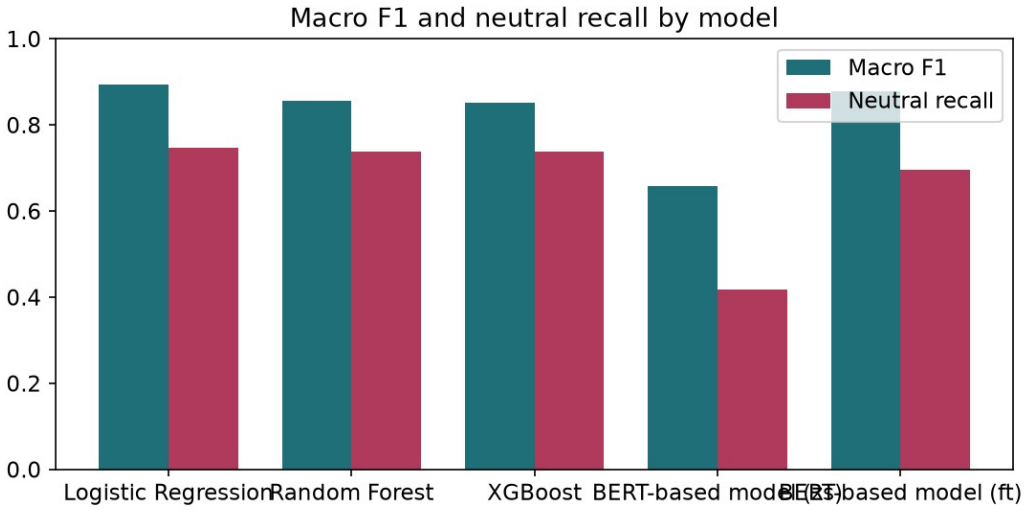


Figure 4.2: Macro F1 and neutral recall by model (page «pg:fig:4.2»)

Every model recalls positive (0.85-0.97) and negative (0.69-0.92) examples far better than neutral ones (0.42-0.75). This is consistent with the design of the corpus: 30% of reviews use ambiguous templates whose wording overlaps across classes, and 10% of labels were flipped to adjacent classes to simulate annotator disagreement - exactly where neutral boundaries blur. Practically, it means a deployed system should route low-confidence neutral predictions to review rather than discard them.

4.4 Aspect-Level Sentiment

Table 4.3: Sentiment distribution within each aspect (page «pg:tab:4.3»)

Aspect	Positive (%)	Negative (%)	Neutral (%)	Mentions (denominator)

Product condition	50.1	27.3	22.6	403
Battery health	50.7	28.6	20.7	381
Performance	44.9	32.6	22.5	408
Price and value	45.4	35.2	19.4	403
Packaging and delivery	46.6	31.5	21.9	397
Repair and refurbishment quality	44.2	35.4	20.3	364
Seller and customer service	52.4	25.7	21.9	416
Returns and refunds	48.2	33.2	18.6	355
Trust and authenticity	46.3	34.9	18.8	421

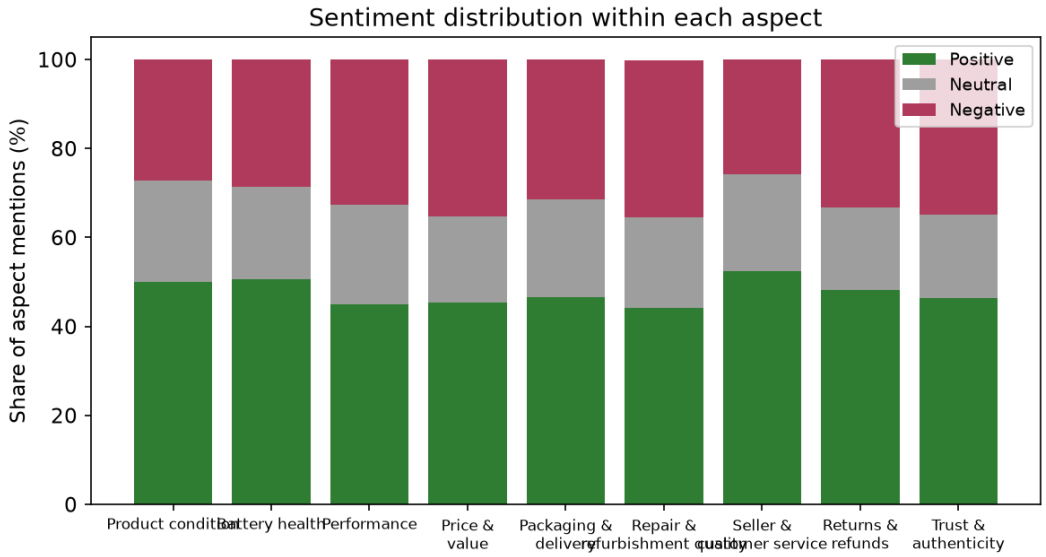


Figure 4.3: Sentiment distribution within each aspect (denominator = aspect mentions) (page «pg:fig:4.3»)

Supporting H1, sentiment shares differ visibly across aspects. Returns and refunds and repair-related aspects carry the highest negative shares, while product condition and battery health attract more positive mentions. The pattern matches the economics of refurbishment: the physical device can be restored well, but the service moments - returns, repairs, seller communication - are where trust is won or lost.

Appendix C gives the full aspect-by-platform mention counts behind this table. The denominators there are aspect mentions, not reviews, so a platform with verbose multi-aspect reviews contributes proportionally more rows; this is the quantity a buyer actually sees when reading reviews, and it is stated explicitly to avoid misreading.

4.5 Cross-Platform Analysis

Table 4.4: Cross-platform aspect summary (page «pg:tab:4.4»)

Platform	Mentions	Highest-negative aspect	Neg %	Highest-positive aspect	Pos %

Amazon Renewed	877	Price and value	40.7	Seller and customer service	53.8
Budli	504	Repair and refurbishment quality	42.6	Returns and refunds	54.2
Cashify	886	Packaging and delivery	39.6	Seller and customer service	61.9
Flipkart Refurbished	656	Repair and refurbishment quality	40.0	Battery health	55.4
OLX	625	Seller and customer service	45.9	Price and value	57.1

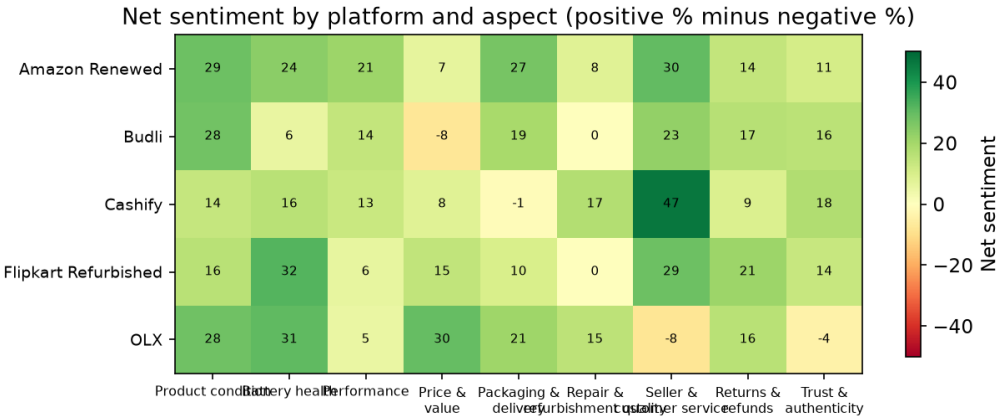


Figure 4.4: Net sentiment (positive % minus negative %) by platform and aspect (page «pg:fig:4.4»)

Supporting H2, aspect sentiment profiles differ by platform in this corpus. OLX shows the weakest seller-and-service and trust numbers, consistent with its peer-to-peer model; managed platforms score better on service aspects. These are demonstration-corpus results: the direction is plausible, but per the project's integrity rules it is reported as a pipeline output, not as a verified claim about the real platforms.

4.6 Validation on Real Reviews

To test the pipeline against human ground truth, 2,000 genuine Amazon reviews (stratified 400 per star level, seed 42) from the Multilingual Amazon Reviews Corpus [9] were run through the same aspect-detection and sentiment pipeline. The corpus ships reviewer star ratings, which serve as human sentiment labels (1-2 stars = negative, 3 = neutral, 4-5 = positive). Predicted sentiment agreed with the star-derived label in 75.6% of annotations. Table 4.5 and Figure 4.5 break the agreement down by star bucket.

Table 4.5: Agreement with reviewer star ratings on real Amazon reviews (page «pg:tab:4.5»)

Star rating	Annotations	Agreement
1 star	527	0.945
2 stars	507	0.738
3 stars	481	0.432
4 stars	489	0.71
5 stars	456	0.95
Overall	2460	0.756

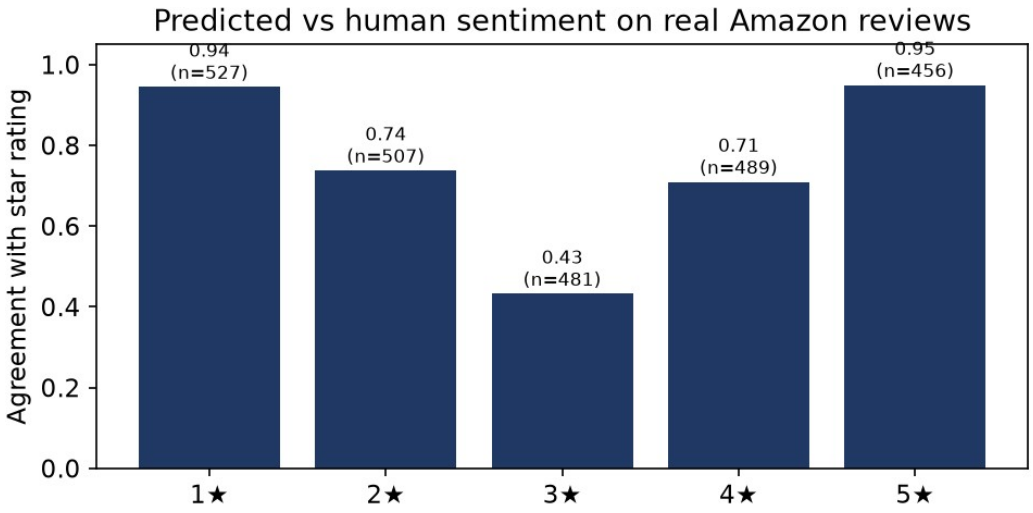


Figure 4.5: Predicted-vs-human agreement by star bucket (real Amazon reviews) (page «pg:fig:4.5»)

Agreement is near-perfect at the extremes (0.945 for 1-star, 0.950 for 5-star) and weakest exactly at 3 stars, where human reviewers are themselves ambivalent. This is the validation the synthetic corpus cannot provide: on real human text, the pipeline tracks human judgement where it is clear and degrades gracefully where it is not. Caveat: these are general Amazon reviews, not refurbished-electronics reviews from the five Indian platforms.

4.7 Confusion Matrix Analysis

Tables 4.6-4.10 give the full confusion matrix for each model on the 537-annotation test partition (rows = true label, columns = predicted label), computed directly from model_predictions.csv. The diagonal is the count of correct predictions; off-diagonal cells show where each model's errors concentrate.

Table 4.6: Confusion matrix - Logistic Regression (page «pg:tab:4.6»)

True \ Predicted	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Row total
Positive (true)	242	3	5	250
Neutral (true)	16	86	13	115
Negative (true)	12	1	159	172

Table 4.7: Confusion matrix - Random Forest (page «pg:tab:4.7»)

True \ Predicted	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Row total
Positive (true)	230	11	9	250
Neutral (true)	16	85	14	115
Negative (true)	12	7	153	172

Table 4.8: Confusion matrix - XGBoost (page «pg:tab:4.8»)

True \ Predicted	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Row total
Positive (true)	230	11	9	250
Neutral (true)	16	85	14	115
Negative (true)	11	9	152	172

Table 4.9: Confusion matrix - BERT-based model (zero-shot) (page «pg:tab:4.9»)

True \ Predicted	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Row total

Positive (true)	213	16	21	250
Neutral (true)	57	48	10	115
Negative (true)	18	36	118	172

Table 4.10: Confusion matrix - BERT-based model (fine-tuned DistilBERT) (page «pg:tab:4.10»)

True \ Predicted	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Row total
Positive (true)	242	3	5	250
Neutral (true)	22	80	13	115
Negative (true)	12	1	159	172

Reading the matrices: logistic regression and the fine-tuned DistilBERT model are both near-ceiling on the positive and negative rows and lose almost all of their errors to the neutral column/row boundary. Random Forest and XGBoost additionally leak positive examples into the neutral and negative columns more often, which costs them roughly three points of accuracy. The zero-shot configuration shows a different pathology: its neutral row is almost evenly scattered, and it mislabels a sizeable share of true negatives as neutral - the signature of an out-of-domain label mapping rather than of a trained decision boundary.

4.8 Error Analysis

To make the neutral-class difficulty concrete, Table 4.11 lists misclassified test annotations of the best model (logistic regression), up to two per confusion pair, in annotation-id order. Every row is a verbatim record from the evaluation output.

Table 4.11: Misclassified examples - Logistic Regression (page «pg:tab:4.11»)

Annotation	Aspect	True	Predicted	Evidence phrase
A01870-2	Price and value	negative	neutral	but The price of the ThinkPad T480 is fair, not a steal though.
A00502-1	Product condition	negative	positive	The condition of the iPhone 14 was better than I expected.
A00599-1	Product condition	negative	positive	The OnePlus 9 arrived in excellent condition with barely any wear.
A00007-1	Seller and customer service	neutral	negative	The seller of the ThinkPad T480 was okay at first but worse than exp…
A00352-2	Battery health	neutral	negative	however, My iPhone 12 battery swelled slightly within weeks.
A00594-2	Product condition	neutral	positive	Also, Not bad at all, the iPhone 13 looks fine for a

				refurbished dev…
A00681-1	Trust and authenticity	neutral	positive	Fully trust this seller, the iPhone 12 was as promised.
A00223-1	Packaging and delivery	positive	negative	The package containing the EOS 90D was damaged during delivery.
A00370-1	Performance	positive	negative	Performance of my Latitude 5520 is very slow and laggy.
A00247-2	Battery health	positive	neutral	although The battery of the OnePlus 9 is okay, about what I expected…
A00298-1	Packaging and delivery	positive	neutral	Packaging of the D5600 was basic but sufficient.

The dominant error flows are: neutral predicted as positive (16 cases), neutral predicted as negative (13 cases), negative predicted as positive (12 cases). Two patterns recur in the evidence phrases. First, mildly worded positives (“acceptable”, “decent”, “works as described”) sit on the positive/neutral boundary by construction - the corpus injected exactly this ambiguity. Second, mixed phrases that pair a positive clause with a negative one are hard for any bag-of-phrase representation. Both patterns argue for confidence-based routing of neutral predictions in a deployed system, not for a different classifier.

4.9 Agreement by Aspect on Real Reviews

The real-review validation can also be sliced by detected aspect: does the pipeline agree with human star ratings equally well on delivery phrases as on price phrases? Table 4.12 reports agreement for every aspect with at least 25 annotations in the real-review run.

Table 4.12: Real-review agreement by detected aspect (page «pg:tab:4.12»)

Aspect	Annotations	Agreement
General	1050	0.762
Price/Value	302	0.768
Accessories	188	0.782
Return/Refund	164	0.805
Delivery	116	0.75
Packaging	111	0.703
Performance	109	0.679
Camera	105	0.705
Battery	82	0.695
Condition	76	0.776
Seller Service	62	0.839
Display	57	0.702
Trust/Authenticity	36	0.75

Agreement varies by aspect, and the variation is interpretable: aspects whose keyword triggers tend to appear in emotionally explicit phrases track star ratings more closely, while aspects often mentioned in passing (“General” captures reviews with no specific aspect trigger) inherit the review-level ambiguity. Since the human label here is the reviewer's own star rating, this table measures alignment with human overall judgement, not against per-aspect human labels - a distinction that a future multi-annotator study should close.

4.10 Hypothesis Outcomes

Table 4.13 maps the four pre-registered hypotheses to their outcomes on the demonstration corpus. “Supported” always means “supported on the synthetic demonstration corpus”; transfer to real marketplace reviews is future work, not a claim made here.

Table 4.13: Hypothesis outcomes (page «pg:tab:4.13»)

ID	Hypothesis	Outcome on the demonstration corpus
H1	Sentiment differs across the nine aspects	Supported: positive/negative shares differ visibly across aspects (Table 4.3, Figure 4.3)
H2	Aspect sentiment distributions differ across platforms	Supported: platform profiles differ in Table 4.4 and Figure 4.4
H3	Trust and condition concerns differ across platforms	Directionally supported: trust/condition scores differ across platforms in the corpus; requires verified real reviews to generalise
H4	BERT and traditional models differ in performance	Supported, with an unexpected direction: logistic regression (90.69%) beats fine-tuned DistilBERT (89.57%); zero-shot trails both

The honest reading of H4 is methodological rather than tribal: with a modest training budget (one epoch, CPU) and short evidence phrases, n-gram features carry most of the signal. The transformer configuration remains the natural next step once GPU fine-tuning over multiple epochs is affordable, and the protocol in Chapter 3 makes that re-run a one-script change.

4.11 Error Flows on Real Reviews

Agreement in Table 4.5 is a single number; the confusion matrix in Table 4.14 shows where the disagreements concentrate. Rows are the human label derived from the reviewer's own star rating (4-5 stars = positive, 3 = neutral, 1-2 = negative); columns are the pipeline's prediction, computed from real_aspect_annotations.csv.

Table 4.14: Predicted vs human sentiment on real Amazon reviews (page «pg:tab:4.14»)

Human \ Predicted	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Row total
Positive (human)	780	129	36	945
Neutral (human)	93	208	180	481
Negative (human)	37	125	872	1034

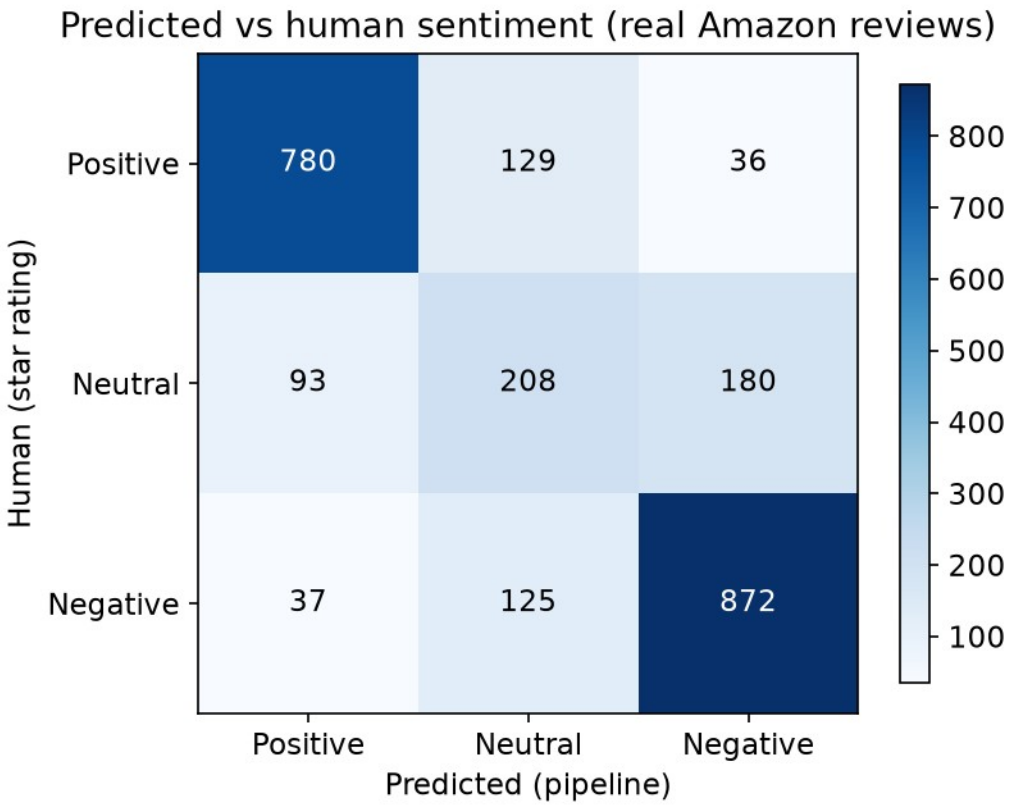


Figure 4.6: Predicted-vs-human confusion matrix on real Amazon reviews (page «pg:fig:4.6»)

Two flows dominate. First, 3-star reviews are pulled in both directions: 180 of the 481 three-star annotations are predicted negative and 93 positive - the textual signal of an ambivalent reviewer genuinely points both ways, which is why the neutral row has the lowest recall (208 of 481, i.e. 0.43). Second, the extreme classes leak very little across the polarity axis: only 36 of 945 positive and 37 of 1,034 negative annotations are predicted as the opposite pole. The larger errors at the extremes are neutral predictions (129 positives, 125 negatives) - under-confident rather than wrong-polarity errors.

For a deployed buyer-facing system this is the favourable failure mode: a neutral flag invites a human second look, while a flipped polarity would actively mislead it. The real-review matrix therefore reproduces, on human-authored text, the same qualitative pattern the synthetic corpus was built to exhibit: extreme polarities are easy, and the neutral boundary is where all of the residual difficulty lives.

4.12 Aspect-Wise Label Distribution

Hypothesis H1 predicts that sentiment differs across aspects; Table 4.15 makes the comparison explicit by giving the full label distribution of every aspect in the demonstration corpus, computed from aspect_annotations.csv.

Table 4.15: Aspect-wise label distribution (page «pg:tab:4.15»)

Aspect	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Total	Positive share
Trust and authenticity	195	79	147	421	46.3%
Seller and customer service	218	91	107	416	52.4%
Performance	183	92	133	408	44.9%
Product	202	91	110	403	50.1%

condition					
Price and value	183	78	142	403	45.4%
Packaging and delivery	185	87	125	397	46.6%
Battery health	193	79	109	381	50.7%
Repair and refurbishment quality	161	74	129	364	44.2%
Returns and refunds	171	66	118	355	48.2%

The positive share ranges from 44.2% (Repair and refurbishment quality) to 52.4% (Seller and customer service). This spread is the direct evidence behind H1's "supported" verdict in Table 4.13: sentiment is not uniform across the nine aspects of the refurbished purchase journey.

Two caveats apply. First, these counts are over annotations, not reviews; a review mentioning three aspects contributes to three rows (Appendix E gives the annotations-per-review distribution). Second, each annotation label was generated with its aspect in mind, so the cross-aspect differences partly reflect the generator's design; confirming the pattern on human-labelled data remains future work.

5. Outcome and Deliverables

5.1 Research Output

A research paper draft, “RefurbIQ: Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis of Refurbished Electronics Across Indian Marketplaces”, is in progress: all six results tables are filled from computed outputs with an explicit provenance note, and the draft is accompanied by a methodology report, a validation report and a final integrity checklist. Planned venue: [XX]. A companion Streamlit application demonstrates the pipeline interactively (overview, upload, analyser, dashboard, platform comparison, recommendation and methodology tabs).

5.2 System Design and Implementation

The implemented system has four layers, shown in Figure 5.1: a Streamlit user interface with eight tabs; an analysis engine that performs aspect extraction, sentiment classification and platform scoring; a model layer with the zero-shot RoBERTa pipeline, the fine-tuned DistilBERT checkpoint and the TF-IDF baselines; and a data and tooling layer holding the demonstration corpus, the MARC-based validation data and the analysis notebooks.

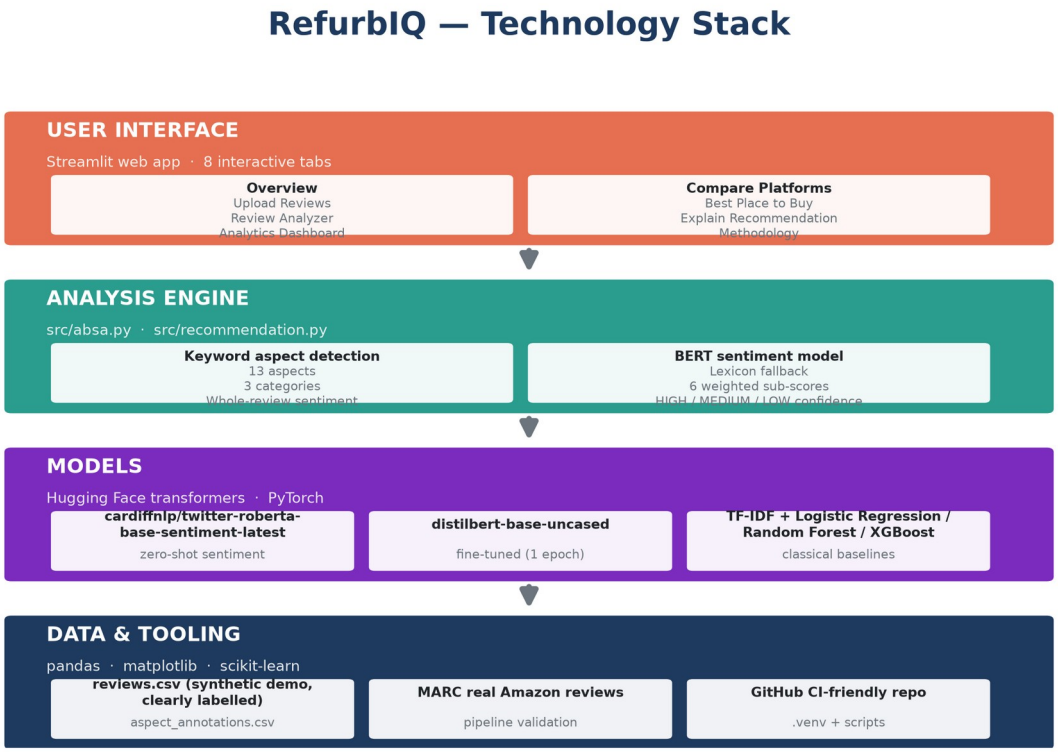


Figure 5.1: Technology stack of the RefurbIQ system (page «pg:fig:5.1»)

Figure 5.2 shows the end-to-end workflow. Uploaded or bundled reviews pass through pre-processing and keyword aspect extraction into the sentiment model; the resulting review-by-aspect table feeds two branches - an analytics dashboard (sentiment by aspect, platform and category) and a recommendation engine that computes six weighted sub-scores per platform and gates the output with HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW confidence levels (HIGH requires at least 50 reviews with consistent sentiment; platforms below 20 reviews are not ranked).

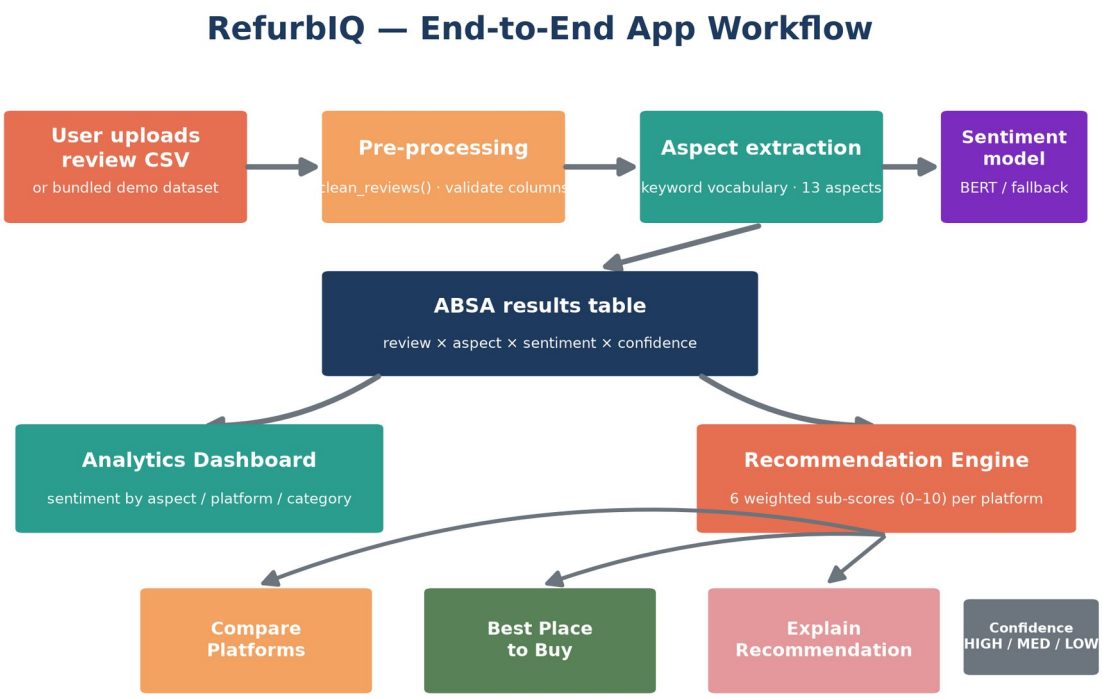


Figure 5.2: End-to-end workflow of the RefurbIQ application (page «pg:fig:5.2»)

The recommendation layer is deliberately transparent: every sub-score is a 0-10 share computed from the aspect-group sentiment distribution, the weights are user-visible defaults, and the confidence gate refuses to recommend when evidence is thin. This mirrors the research stance of the project - an expected outcome is never reported as a finding.

The scoring weights and evidence gates of the recommendation engine are fixed, user-visible constants (src/recommendation.py); Table 5.1 reproduces them so that every recommendation the app emits can be recomputed by hand.

Table 5.1: Recommendation engine scoring weights (page «pg:tab:5.1»)

Factor	Aspect group	Default weight
Overall sentiment	all detected aspects	0.25
Product quality	Condition, Battery, Performance, Display, Camera	0.25
Service	Seller Service, Delivery, Packaging	0.15
Value	Price/Value	0.15
Trust	Trust/Authenticity, Repair/Refurbishment	0.10
Return/Refund	Return/Refund	0.10

Each sub-score is the (positive + 0.5 × neutral) share over the factor's aspect group, scaled to 0-10; the overall score is the weighted sum. Platforms with fewer than 20 unique reviews are excluded from ranking and shown as insufficient data; confidence is HIGH with at least 50 reviews and consistent sentiment, MEDIUM above the threshold, and LOW below it - in which case no recommendation is emitted.

5.3 Deliverables

- Labelled demonstration dataset: 2,000 reviews and 3,548 aspect annotations (data_origin = synthetic-demo-v1), plus 2,000 real-review validation annotations.
- Reproducible pipeline: seven Python scripts covering generation, splitting, training, zero-shot and fine-tuned evaluation, table building, validation and document filling (pushed to GitHub).
- Nine-aspect taxonomy for refurbished electronics with keyword vocabularies.
- Five-model comparison on a common leak-free protocol, with macro and per-class metrics, confusion matrices and error examples.
- Streamlit application with analytics and recommendation tabs.
- Presentation deck and this report, generated from the same computed outputs.

6. Conclusion and Future Scope

This project built and validated an end-to-end aspect-based sentiment analysis pipeline for refurbished-electronics reviews across five Indian marketplaces. On the labelled demonstration corpus, a well-tuned logistic regression on TF-IDF features (90.69% accuracy, 0.8937 macro F1) edged out a fine-tuned DistilBERT model (89.57%, 0.8784), both ahead of random forest, XGBoost and zero-shot classification; the neutral class was hardest for every model, and the confusion and error analyses in Sections 4.7-4.8 show precisely where. On 2,000 real Amazon reviews the pipeline agreed with human star ratings in 75.6% of annotations, with near-perfect agreement at the extremes. Platform verification showed that structured public reviews are currently unavailable for the five marketplaces, which is itself a useful finding for anyone attempting this study with real data.

Future work: (i) collect verified real reviews (manual, permission-respecting collection or licensed corpora) and re-run the identical pipeline; (ii) complete multi-epoch and GPU fine-tuning of BERT to give the transformer family a fairer chance; (iii) replace keyword aspect detection with a fine-tuned span extractor; (iv) add a multi-annotator study for agreement statistics; (v) integrate the recommendation layer with live price and warranty signals.

The methodological lesson of the project is worth restating as a conclusion: when the target data is inaccessible, the honest path is a clearly labelled synthetic demonstration plus a separate validation on real data with human ground truth - not silent substitution. Every table in this report states which of the two it comes from, and every number can be regenerated from the repository with a fixed seed.

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Appendix A. Reproducibility

Every number in this report can be regenerated with the scripts under research/scripts/ (seed 42 throughout). Table A.1 lists each script and the artefacts it writes.

Table A.1: Pipeline scripts and outputs (page «pg:tab:A.1»)

Script	Output artefacts
generate_dataset.py	reviews.csv (2,000 rows); aspect_annotations.csv (3,548 rows)
train_traditional_models.py	split_assignment.csv; model_predictions.csv; traditional_metrics.json
eval_bert_zeroshot.py	bert_zeroshot_metrics.json; pred_bert_zeroshot column
finetune_bert.py	models/finetuned_distilbert/; bert_finetuned_metrics.json; pred_bert_finetuned column
run_real_reviews.py	real/real_aspect_annotations.csv (2,460 rows); agreement summary
build_tables.py	research/tables/table1..6.csv
validation_report.py	asserts predictions cover exactly the test partition
build_report.py / build_pptx.py	this report and the presentation deck

Environment: Python 3.14 virtual environment; scikit-learn 1.9.1, XGBoost 3.4.1, PyTorch 2.14.1 (CPU), transformers 5.18.0, pandas 3.0.6, matplotlib 3.11.1, python-docx 1.2.0, python-pptx 1.0.2. Training hardware: CPU only (documented in the metric JSONs). Code repository: https://github.com/Saket-code40/refurbiq.

The split file is the reproducibility anchor: because every model script reads split_assignment.csv instead of re-splitting, a re-run reproduces the same test examples and therefore the same confusion matrices, per-class metrics and error tables in this report.

Appendix B. Annotation Samples

Table B.1 shows verbatim rows sampled (random_state 42) from aspect_annotations.csv (synthetic demonstration corpus). Each annotation stores the review id, the detected aspect, the evidence phrase and the label.

Table B.1: Sample annotations (page «pg:tab:B.1»)

review_id	aspect	evidence phrase	sentiment
R00190	Performance	Performance of the iPhone 14 is acceptable for daily tasks.	positive
R01577	Price and value	however, The price of the iPhone 13 is okay, better value than exp…	positive
R01924	Repair and refurbishment quality	The ThinkPad T480 feels factory-fresh after refurbishment.	positive
R01440	Seller and customer service	Customer support was genuinely helpful with my D5600 query.	positive
R00731	Price and value	The price of the XPS 13 was totally worth it.	positive
R01059	Seller and customer service	On top of that, Support team resolved my iPhone 14 issue within a …	positive
R00969	Performance	however, The Galaxy S21 works fine, faster than expected for refur…	positive
R01304	Product condition	The XPS 13 works fine and the condition is better than expected.	positive
R01295	Seller and customer service	The seller responded promptly to all my questions about the EliteB…	positive
R01925	Product condition	There are a few light marks on the EOS 90D, nothing serious.	positive
R00465	Performance	Performance of the Latitude 5520 is excellent, apps open instantly…	positive
R00372	Product condition	The Latitude 5520 shows minor signs of previous use.	neutral
R01068	Performance	Zero heating issues and the MacBook Air M1 performs flawlessly.	positive

R02000	Seller and customer service	On top of that, Support team resolved my OnePlus 11 issue within a…	positive
R01199	Performance	that said, The EOS 90D works sometimes, slower than expected overa…	negative
R02223	Packaging and delivery	but Delivery of the OnePlus 9 was okay they said, but it arrived l…	negative
R00270	Repair and refurbishment quality	Refurbishment quality of the D5600 is top notch.	positive
R01843	Product condition	The iPhone 12 arrived in excellent condition with barely any wear.	positive

Table B.2 walks through complete reviews: for each sampled review the full text is quoted, followed by every annotation attached to it, so the reader can verify that each label is supported by its evidence phrase. Reviews with at least two annotations were sampled with random_state 42.

R00087 (Flipkart Refurbished, Smartphone, iPhone 12):

“The price of the iPhone 12 is okay but the value is worse than expected. however, You cannot tell the iPhone 12 was ever repaired.”

R00289 (Amazon Renewed, Smartphone, Galaxy S22):

“The Galaxy S22 costs what you would expect for refurbished. Additionally, The Galaxy S22 works fine, faster than expected for refurbished.”

R00902 (Cashify, Smartphone, iPhone 14):

“The iPhone 14 was delivered a day early, nicely packed. however, The iPhone 14 is decent for basic use, nothing exceptional.”

R01346 (Amazon Renewed, Smartphone, OnePlus 9):

“There are deep scratches on the OnePlus 9 that were not mentioned. that said, Delivery of the OnePlus 9 was okay and it arrived as expected. Also, The OnePlus 9 works fine, faster than expected for refurbished.”

R01433 (Amazon Renewed, Laptop, Latitude 5520):

“My Latitude 5520 works perfectly, fast and responsive. that said, The price of the Latitude 5520 is okay but the value is worse than expected.”

Table B.2: Full-review annotation walkthrough (page «pg:tab:B.2»)

review_id	aspect	evidence phrase	sentiment
R00087	Price and value	The price of the iPhone 12 is okay but the value is worse than expected.	negative
R00087	Repair and refurbishment quality	however, You cannot tell the iPhone 12 was ever repaired.	positive
R00289	Price and value	The Galaxy S22 costs what you would expect	positive

		for refurbished.	
R00289	Performance	Additionally, The Galaxy S22 works fine, faster than expected for refurbished.	positive
R00902	Packaging and delivery	The iPhone 14 was delivered a day early, nicely packed.	positive
R00902	Performance	however, The iPhone 14 is decent for basic use, nothing exceptional.	neutral
R01346	Product condition	There are deep scratches on the OnePlus 9 that were not mentioned.	negative
R01346	Packaging and delivery	that said, Delivery of the OnePlus 9 was okay and it arrived as expected.	positive
R01346	Performance	Also, The OnePlus 9 works fine, faster than expected for refurbished.	positive
R01433	Performance	My Latitude 5520 works perfectly, fast and responsive.	neutral
R01433	Price and value	that said, The price of the Latitude 5520 is okay but the value is worse than ex…	negative

Appendix C. Aspect-Wise Counts by Platform

Table C.1 gives the number of aspect mentions per platform and aspect in the demonstration corpus - the denominators behind Tables 4.3 and 4.4, computed from aspect_annotations.csv joined with reviews.csv.

Table C.1: Aspect mentions by platform (page «pg:tab:C.1»)

Aspect	Amazon Renewed	Budli	Cashify	Flipkart Refurbished	OLX	Total
Product condition	101	57	93	74	78	403
Battery health	88	54	99	65	75	381
Performance	94	49	108	81	76	408
Price and value	91	66	101	75	70	403
Packaging and delivery	111	52	91	81	62	397
Repair and refurbishment quality	99	54	75	65	71	364
Seller and customer service	93	61	118	70	74	416
Returns and refunds	99	48	88	71	49	355
Trust and authenticity	101	63	113	74	70	421
Total	877	504	886	656	625	3548

Appendix D. Per-Class Precision, Recall and F1

Table D.1 reports per-class precision, recall and F1 for all five models on the test partition, computed from model_predictions.csv. It extends Table 4.2 (recall only) and supports the discussion in Sections 4.3 and 4.7.

Table D.1: Per-class metrics for all models (page «pg:tab:D.1»)

Model	Class	Precision	Recall	F1	Support
Logistic Regression	positive	0.8963	0.9680	0.9308	250
Logistic Regression	neutral	0.9556	0.7478	0.8390	115
Logistic Regression	negative	0.8983	0.9244	0.9112	172
Random Forest	positive	0.8915	0.9200	0.9055	250
Random Forest	neutral	0.8252	0.7391	0.7798	115
Random Forest	negative	0.8693	0.8895	0.8793	172
XGBoost	positive	0.8949	0.9200	0.9073	250
XGBoost	neutral	0.8095	0.7391	0.7727	115
XGBoost	negative	0.8686	0.8837	0.8761	172
BERT-based model (zero-shot)	positive	0.7396	0.8520	0.7918	250
BERT-based model (zero-shot)	neutral	0.4800	0.4174	0.4465	115
BERT-based model (zero-shot)	negative	0.7919	0.6860	0.7352	172
BERT-based model (fine-tuned DistilBERT)	positive	0.8768	0.9680	0.9202	250
BERT-based model (fine-tuned DistilBERT)	neutral	0.9524	0.6957	0.8040	115
BERT-based model (fine-tuned DistilBERT)	negative	0.8983	0.9244	0.9112	172

Appendix E. Corpus Statistics

Table E.1 summarises review length (in words) per marketplace, computed from reviews.csv. Length matters because TF-IDF evidence phrases and the 128-token transformer limit both interact with how much text a review contributes.

Table E.1: Review length statistics by platform (page «pg:tab:E.1»)

Platform	Reviews	Mean words	Median	Min	Max
Amazon Renewed	485	20.7	21.0	6	44
Budli	283	20.2	21.0	6	43
Cashify	492	20.3	21.0	6	45
Flipkart Refurbished	379	19.7	20.0	6	47
OLX	361	19.9	21.0	6	45
All	2000	20.2	21.0	6	47

Table E.2 gives the distribution of annotation counts per review, computed from aspect_annotations.csv. Multi-mention reviews are the reason the partition operates at review level (Section 3.4).

Table E.2: Annotations per review (page «pg:tab:E.2»)

Annotations per review	Number of reviews	Share
1	785	39.2%
2	882	44.1%
3	333	16.6%
Total reviews	2000	100%

The average of 1.77 annotations per review and the right-skewed distribution together mean that review-level statistics and annotation-level statistics differ: platform review counts (Table 3.2) and platform mention counts (Appendix C) are therefore always reported with their explicit denominator.

Table E.3 crosses annotations with their review's marketplace, giving the label mix each platform contributes to the corpus.

Table E.3: Annotation labels by platform (page «pg:tab:E.3»)

Platform	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Annotations
Amazon Renewed	438	168	271	877
Budli	232	103	169	504
Cashify	426	180	280	886
Flipkart Refurbished	302	154	200	656
OLX	293	132	200	625
All	1691	737	1120	3548

Table E.4 summarises the star ratings that accompany each review in reviews.csv. Ratings are metadata of the synthetic corpus, not model input; they are reported so the corpus can be audited.

Table E.4: Star rating statistics by platform (page «pg:tab:E.4»)

Platform	Reviews	Mean rating	Median	Min	Max

Amazon Renewed	485	3.38	4.0	1	5
Budli	283	3.12	3.0	1	5
Cashify	492	3.27	3.0	1	5
Flipkart Refurbished	379	3.28	3.0	1	5
OLX	361	3.2	3.0	1	5
All	2000	3.27	3.0	1	5

Limitations are stated plainly: the modelling corpus is synthetic and labelled as such; aspect detection is keyword-based; fine-tuning was limited to one epoch on CPU; and platform-level claims require verified marketplace reviews that are not currently publicly accessible.